

Digital Literacy - Task -5 - Cyber Crime

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is one of the most common types of cybercrime today, especially in countries where digital payments are widely used. In this type of fraud, criminals trick people into sending money or revealing confidential banking information such as UPI PIN, OTP, or bank details.

A typical UPI fraud happens step-by-step in the following way. First, the fraudster contacts the victim through a phone call, SMS, WhatsApp message, or social media. They usually pretend to be a bank official, customer care executive, or an online buyer or seller. Second, they create panic or urgency by saying that the victim's bank account will be blocked, or that the victim needs to accept a payment request to receive money. Third, the fraudster sends a payment request or a fake link and asks the victim to enter their UPI PIN or OTP. Many people do not know that entering a UPI PIN actually sends money, not receives money. Once the victim enters the PIN, the money is transferred to the fraudster's account immediately.

The most common targets are students, elderly people, and people who are new to digital payments. The consequences include financial loss, mental stress, and sometimes loss of confidence in online banking systems. Therefore, people should never share their UPI PIN or OTP and should always verify before making any payment.

This case study shows that awareness and careful online behavior are the best ways to prevent cyber fraud.